

## 15 Day Osaka->Nakasendo->Karuizawa->Katsatsu Onsen->Tokyo

Trip focus: nature, birding, onsen. Some art, shopping on the side.

| Day   | Date (tentative) | Route Overview                                                                                     | Details                                                                                                                                                          | Distance                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Accommodation                                                                                                                                            | Attire                                                                     | Pack                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                        |
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| Day 0 | 10/9/2026        | SFO -> Osaka                                                                                       | <a href="#">EVA (see Flights)</a>                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                        |
| Day 1 | 10/10/2026       | Osaka Arrival                                                                                      | * Arrive KIX 10:10AM<br>* Train to Osaka<br>* Arriving around 12:30<br>* Relax                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | TBD                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                        |
| Day 2 | 10/11/2026       | Osaka Relax Day                                                                                    | Activities TBD:<br>• Osaka Kitchen Street<br>• Teamlab Osaka (Night time 6:00pm ) ?                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                        |
| Day 3 | 10/12/2026       | Osaka<br>-> Nakatsugawa(中津川市)<br>(Overnight Nakatsugawa)                                           | * Osaka -> Nagoya (~50 min Shinkansen)<br>* Nagoya -> Nakatsugawa (~1 hr 15 min JR)<br>* Overnight Nakatsugawa<br>* Arrange luggage forwarding to Kiso-Fukushima | Nakatsugawa is a small city that serves as a gateway to the historic Nakasendō trail and the Kiso Valley region.<br><br>Stock up on items if needed like:<br>* Cash (Local train tickets cash only)<br>* Snacks<br>* Bottled water<br><br>Luggage Forwarding options:<br>~3000Y per suitcase<br>* 宅急便 (たっきゅうびん)<br>* <a href="#">Walk Lite Nakasendo</a><br>* <a href="#">Nakasendo Luggage Transfer Service</a>                                 | TBD                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                        |
| Day 4 | 10/13/2026       | Nakatsugawa<br>-> Magome (馬籠宿)<br>-> Tsumago (妻籠宿)<br>(Overnight Tsumago)                          | * Drop off luggage for forwarding<br>* Bus to Magome-juku (~30 min)<br>* Hike -> Tsumago-juku (~3-5 hrs)<br>* Overnight Tsumago                                  | The Magome-to-Tsumago hike is the most famous section of the historic Nakasendō, an old samurai-era route that once connected Kyoto and Tokyo.<br><br>It's a scenic walk through:<br>* cedar forests<br>* mountain villages<br>* waterfalls<br>* quiet countryside roads<br>* preserved Edo-period post towns<br><br>NOTE: Business hours in the post towns are 9:00 AM – 4:30 PM<br><br><a href="#">Read More : Complete Guide to Nakasendo</a> | Walking distance: 5.2 miles<br>Elevation ascent: 1,069 ft<br>Elevation descent: 1,410 ft<br>Time required: About 4 hours<br>Difficulty: Easy to Moderate | <a href="#">妻籠宿 上丁子屋</a><br><a href="#">Hut in Nagiso</a><br>(長野県南木曽町の古民家) | Good enough:<br>* sneakers or trail runners<br>* light daypack<br><br>Helpful:<br>* rain jacket<br>* spare socks (if it rains)<br>* small towel<br>* trekking poles only if your knees dislike downhill walking | * sunscreen<br>* water<br>* snack<br>* overnight needs |
| Day 5 | 10/14/2026       | Tsumago<br>-> Kiso-Fukushima(木曽福島)<br>(Overnight Kiso-Fukushima)                                   | * Morning Tsumago walk to Nagiso (2hr)<br>* Train to Kiso-Fukushima (~45–60 min)<br>* Onsen + slow town day                                                      | Explore the historic Kiso-Fukushima: 禪興寺; 山村代官下屋敷: historical street; old buildings with stilt support along the river; lots of good restaurants and shops.<br>Matsumoto: Castle ; hotel has indoor spa.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                        |
| Day 6 | 10/15/2026       | Atera Valley(阿寺溪谷)<br>(Overnight Kiso-Fukushima)                                                   | * Train to Nojiri (30 min)<br>* Taxi to entrance (5 min)<br>* Relaxed easy scenic forest walk along the river                                                    | Atera Valley is one of the most underrated nature spots in the Kiso region—emerald river water, smooth rock formations, and quiet forest trails with very few crowds.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Most scenic area is about 1 hour walk from the entrance.<br>~30 min from the Suspension bridge<br><a href="#">Field Guide of Atera Valley</a>            |                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                        |
| Day 7 | 10/16/2026       | Torii pass hike [optional]<br>(Yabuhara -> Narai)<br><br>Narai(奈良井口)<br>(Overnight Kiso-Fukushima) | * Train to Yubahara (~ 20min)<br>* Torii pass hike (2.5-4hr)<br>* Explore Narai (1-2 hr)<br>* Train back to Kiso-Fukushima (~10min)                              | Torii pass is a quieter, more atmospheric stretches of the old samurai route, crossing a mountain pass through dense cedar forest.<br>* Steady forest climb out of Narai<br>* Gentle ridge walking at the pass<br>* Longer, easier descent into Yabuhara                                                                                                                                                                                         | * Distance: ~5–6 km<br>* Time: ~2.5–4 hours<br>* Difficulty: Moderate<br>* Elevation gain: 650 ft<br>* Elevation descent: 1000 ft                        | <a href="#">木曽三河家</a>                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                        |

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| Day 8  | 10/17/2026 | Kiso-Fukushima<br>->Matsumoto(松本市)<br>(Overnight Matsumoto) | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>* ~1.5–2 hrs travel</li> <li>* Matsumoto Castle</li> <li>* Nawate Street and Nakamachi Street</li> <li>* Matsumoto City Museum of Art — Best overall Yayoi Kusama (草間 彌生) collection</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | * JR Shinano ~45min                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                 | <a href="#">三引屋MITSUBIKIYA</a><br><br><a href="#">Family Suite</a> |  |  |
| Day 9  | 10/18/2026 | Matsumoto<br>-> Karuizawa(軽井沢)<br>(Overnight Karuizawa)     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>* Matsumoto → Shinano (~1.5–2 hrs)</li> <li>* Shinano → Karuizawa (~25 min Shinkansen)</li> <li>* Total ~2.5 hrs</li> <li>* Afternoon arrival</li> <li>* Kumoba Pond</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <a href="#">What to do in Karuizawa</a><br>: Want to see <a href="#">Flying squirrels?</a>                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                 |                                                                    |  |  |
| Day 10 | 10/19/2026 | Full Karuizawa day<br>(Overnight Karuizawa)                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Hoshino Forest (Early Bird Walk)</li> <li>• Karuizawa Wild Bird Sanctuary (open at 9:30)               <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Easy forest trails</li> <li>- Birdwatching + quiet nature loop</li> </ul> </li> <li>• Shiraito Falls (~25 min bus)</li> <li>• Old Karuizawa Ginza Street               <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- Cafés, shops, relaxed walking</li> </ul> </li> </ul> | <a href="#">Karuizawa National Wild Bird Sanctuary Forest</a><br><br><a href="#">Shiraito Falls</a>                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                 | <a href="#">Compass Globe</a>                                      |  |  |
| Day 11 | 10/20/2026 | Karuizawa<br>->Kusatsu Onsen(草津温泉)<br>(Overnight Kusatsu)   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Direct bus from Karuizawa station (~1.5hrs)</li> <li>• Onsen town arrival</li> <li>• Overnight ryokan</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Renowned for producing massive volumes of highly acidic, mineral-rich water known for skin benefits. The Yubatake (hot water field) in the center of town is a must-see<br><br><a href="#">Onsen List open to foreigners</a><br><a href="#">Bus Schedule</a> (Y2,200) | <a href="#">Onsen Info</a><br><a href="#">Triple Onsen Pass</a> | <a href="#">Maybe: 望雲</a>                                          |  |  |
| Day 12 | 10/21/2026 | Kusatsu<br>-> Tokyo                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>* Direct JR Bus Kanto to Shinjuku (~4hr)</li> <li>* Light evening only (TBD)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <a href="#">Bus Schedule and fare</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                 | TBD                                                                |  |  |
| Day 13 | 10/22/2026 | Tokyo                                                       | TBD<br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Shopping?</li> <li>• Garden Visit?</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                 |                                                                    |  |  |
| Day 14 | 10/23/2026 | Tokyo                                                       | TBD                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                 |                                                                    |  |  |
| Day 15 | 10/24/2026 | Tokyo<br>-> SFO                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                 |                                                                    |  |  |